



WazirX, the halving event needs to be seen in the context where the institutional demand for Bitcoin is already surging, especially via exchange-traded funds (ETFs). “This influx of institutional capital heightens the impact of halving events, fuelling market volatility and speculation,” he says.

For the miners of the Bitcoin cosmos, the halving presents both a challenge and an opportunity. With rewards slashed in half, miners must rev up their computational engines to compete for a smaller slice of the Bitcoin pie.

As for investors, there’s a mix of excitement and trepidation. Will Bitcoin ascend to new astronomical heights? Or will it plunge into a black hole of volatility? For Edul Patel, CEO & Co-Founder of crypto exchange Mudrex, his-

FOR BITCOIN MINERS, HALVING PRESENTS BOTH A CHALLENGE AND AN OPPORTUNITY

torically, halving led to massive price surges for Bitcoin. “For instance, during the first halving in 2012, Bitcoin’s price skyrocketed from \$13 to a peak of \$1,152 the following year,” he notes.

So what should investors do? Experts caution that the only thing they can do is do their own research and diversify. As to what Bitcoin will go through, only time can provide the answer. **BT**

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AVIATION

A Crunch in the Cockpit

The discontentment among pilots at Vistara over the new pay structure may result in a harsh summer for passengers

BY ARNAB DUTTA

► **VISTARA, THE COUNTRY’S** third-largest air carrier, hit a snag of “crew unavailability” in the first week of April, forcing the Gurugram-based airline to cancel many domestic flights. The issue, which has been simmering for some time, will have significant ramifications for the local aviation industry, apart from causing major inconveniences to its passengers, at least over the next few weeks.

The root cause of the Vistara crisis lies in the airline’s inability to reach an agreement with its staff over the new pay structure ahead of its merger with sister concern Air India. According to sources, the restructured pay package that guarantees pilots a minimum flying of 40 hours a week instead of the earlier 70 hours would have resulted in a significant reduction in pay. This caused discontentment, especially among pilots. Pilots were required to accept the new pay structure by March 15.

With the crew seeking sick leave en masse, Vistara had no choice but to cancel its flights—dozens in some days. It dropped its on-time performance (OTP) to 51%.